

Which statement best identifies the promotion of false consciousness in popular media? A magazine article about heart disease in women that emphasizes the role of:

- ☐ A. genetics in the development of heart disease, while overlooking the role of social influences on disease etiology. [19%]
- ☐ B. global inequalities in access to health care, which lead to growing disparities in mortality rates between nations. [2%]
- ✓ ☒ C. individual choices in the development of heart disease, while overlooking the role of systemic inequality in access to health care. [70%]
- ☐ D. social class inequalities in access to health care, which lead to unequal rates of heart disease among the wealthy and poor. [7%]

Correct

70% answered correctly

Explanation:



Social stratification is a system of inequality in which individuals are hierarchically ranked into social classes, with different access to resources and opportunities. **Class consciousness** involves the **recognition** of class structure and an **identification** with **one's own social class** such that individuals understand that people from other classes have needs and interests different from their own.

Marx asserted that individuals in the upper class, to further their own interests, attempt to sway the thinking of those in the lower classes. **False consciousness** results when individuals from **lower classes adopt** the **misleading views** of the upper class and **accept** the **status quo** (ie, injustice, exploitation).

Individuals from the lower classes who do not have class consciousness may blame themselves for undesirable health outcomes or be more likely to agree with media that stress individual responsibility above all other factors. Consequently, adopting false consciousness results in leaving systematic health care inequalities (eg, unequal access or quality) unchallenged.

An article that emphasizes the role of individual choices in the development of heart disease, while overlooking the role of systemic inequality in health care access, promotes *false*

consciousness.

(Choice A) The biomedical approach (not false consciousness) would emphasize the role of physiological causes in the development of heart disease (eg, genetics) while ignoring nonbiological influences (eg, social factors).

(Choice B) An article that emphasizes the role of global inequalities in health disparities better reflects class consciousness (ie, recognition of class structure and class differences), not false consciousness.

(Choice D) An article that emphasizes the role of social class inequalities in the uneven distribution of disease among the wealthy and poor better reflects class consciousness, not false consciousness.

Educational objective:

Class consciousness is the recognition of class structure and identification with one's own social status. False consciousness refers to individuals from lower classes adopting misleading messages from the upper class.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

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System:
Demographics and Social Structure